

You said it...



hang on to Windows only for that reason.

After reading about this matter in the October 2009 issue of *LFY*, I went back to *avasya.jp* hoping that in the meantime Epson would have developed a friendlier Linux installer for the scanner. Sure enough, it was there—a *.deb* file specifically meant for Ubuntu. The scanner was installed in a jiffy through the Ubuntu GUI in just two mouse clicks. Finally, I celebrated my liberation from Windows with a glass of wine.

—**JS Karkada, eddykabootar@ yahoo.com**



Thank you for doing such a wonderful job of promoting the open source concept. To be frank, I was a hardcore Windows user and supporter but after coming across *LFY*, my views have changed a lot and now I use only Linux (CentOS). I like to stay updated about the latest software and especially the operating systems. I don't have a broadband Internet connection, which prevents me from downloading the OS ISO images. But thanks to the *LFY* team, this problem has been taken care of by the magazine providing us with the latest operating systems every month.

After reading the last issue I came to know about the System Rescue CD and I downloaded it. I was quite fascinated by the disk cloning facilities provided by partimage. However, I have a query. If two of my systems have totally dissimilar hardware except the CPU architectures (i.e., if both are x86 systems), will the clone of one of the systems work on the other system?

—**Anirban Saha, anirbansaha2009@gmail.com**

ED: Thanks for sharing your feedback and encouraging us to keep doing better. We are glad that we could help you enjoy the world of open source. As for the query on partimage, I would like to invite the author to take charge.

Rajesh Sola: As far as Linux is concerned, it is highly portable—i.e., the

OS installed on one PC works well with most other systems even if the hardware, besides the CPU architecture, is different. So the same thing applies to images taken by partimage. But most of the time, the display will not work immediately when a graphics card changes. In such a case, you need to modify your */etc/X11/xorg.conf* file as per your new display settings by booting to the fail-safe/recovery mode. When I tried to use an Ubuntu image across systems with AMD, Intel P3 and P4 processors, it worked well on tweaking the display settings.

So the bottom line is compatibility and depends on how a particular OS is portable to different hardware—there is no role played by partimage here. It's like checking the compatibility of an OS when the hard disk is removed from one machine and plugged into other.

A small clarification on the term 'cloning' used in the query: 'cloning' means to copy the disk or partitions (which is done by *g4u*). The operations done by partimage can be referred to as imaging or back-up/restore partitions.



You guys really rock and I like your site. I looked for an option to submit a case study/article but I couldn't find any direct option. Could I know the procedure? Also, I wanted to know whether you only accepted articles based on Linux?

—**Malini, malithenerd@gmail.com**

ED: Thanks! The 'Write for Us' link is on the website's top grey bar :) Here's the direct link www.linuxforu.com/write-for-linux-for-you.



I read *LFY* regularly and feel very happy about the content and presentation. It is very informative for students as well as the faculty members, especially for those who pursue the FOSS philosophy. We, at the department of computer science and engineering, Govt. Engineering College

Sreekrishnapuram, Palakkad, Kerala, have completely switched to Linux, and have started reaping the benefits.

At the same time, I have a feeling that a magazine such as yours shall not promote negative tendencies like animosity towards a firm or product (Microsoft or any other) and should discourage events like Winblast (mentioned in Aug09 issue as part of a FOSSday celebration). Our approach should be based only on technical considerations and let the consumer decide which is best for him.

I would also like to mention that a student group graduated from our institution has set up a reasonably successful venture specializing in ERP solutions based on Open Source Software at the Technology-Business Incubator at National Institute of Calicut.

—**Dr P C Reghu Raj, professor and head, department of computer science and engineering**

ED: Thank you for sharing your valuable feedback. We're indeed delighted to know about the 100 per cent FOSS-powered department of computer science at your college. Also please pass on our congratulations to the students who undertook the project at the National Institute of Calicut.

We also appreciate your concerns regarding 'Microsoft bashing'. As a magazine, we certainly don't encourage animosity towards any firm or product. The Winblast event is just an inside joke, and is quite widespread across colleges. Anyway, we'd try to keep away from 'useless' Microsoft bashing whenever required.

Please send your comments or suggestions to:
The Editor

LINUX FOR YOU Magazine
D-87/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase I,
New Delhi 110020

Phone: 011-26810601/02/03

Fax: 011-26817563

Email: lfyedit@efyindia.com

Website: www.openTis.com